

THE DESIGN AND CONSTRUCTION OF ROYAL ENTRIES IN THE LATE MIDDLE AGES

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In the early months of 1458, the *échevins* of Nevers were planning a formal, ceremonial Entry of their countess, Marie d'Albret. She had been Countess of Nevers for almost two years, since her marriage to Charles de Bourgogne, but this was to be her first formal entry into the capital of her county and would take place on the 9th of April.¹ For the most part, the pageants were drawn from the commonplace repertoire of topics for the receptions of queens in the fifteenth century: the almost obligatory Jesse Tree to depict the Countess Marie to be a type of Mary the Virgin Mother, thereby envisioning the Countess' expected role as the mother of a future Count. Then there was to be a fountain spouting wine, water, and milk followed immediately by a tableau depicting the *Histoire des nopces Archedeclin* (the Wedding at Cana, where Christ miraculously changed water into wine). These two together staged one of the most popular and potent staged encounters in the repertoire of the medieval civic Entry: the water fountain that miraculously spouts wine at the approach of the prince. The two pageants thus bristle with suggestions that the countess' marriage is not only sacramental, but one in which the transubstantiary and miraculous powers of the heavenly *sponsus* are made manifest through the agency of the *sponsa* who comes to be crowned.² Perhaps a tableau depicting the *Moralité de Joseph de Gypte* may leave us wondering. But as Gertrud Schiller points out, images of 'Joseph honoured by his brethren' in Egypt sometimes serve as Epiphany motifs, particularly as analogues of the Visit of the Magi. If the pageant were meant in this way, then this topic would appropriately reflect the conventional epiphany ideas of the Royal Entry, particularly female ones.³ On the face of it at least, perhaps a final tableau the *Histoire de Vespasien* may seem much more unconventional. Almost certainly a depiction of the Siege of Jerusalem, it must have evoked to the town's *mystère* of the Destruction of Jerusalem.⁴

As I have argued elsewhere, Royal Entry pageants generally serve as symbolic epiphanies. As the sovereign or consort approaches each station, the encounter with a pageant image presents the visitor symbolically to the townsmen so that they might recognize and acclaim the ruler's symbolic epiphany. The Jesse Tree and *Histoire des nopces Archedeclin* obviously

function in this way, and *Joseph of Gipte* may well have done so too. The *Destruction of Jerusalem* pageant, however, most clearly functions the other way around. Instead of presenting the Countess to the people of Nevers, it serves as a manifestation of the town to the Countess by means of a *tableau vivant* version of one of Nevers' proudest and most distinctive accomplishments.

Perhaps the most interesting feature of all these arrangements for the Duchess' first Entry into the town, however, was not pageants but the processional actors that the *échevins* of Nevers decreed should accompany her. Almost certainly borrowing an idea from the records of the Royal Entry of Henry VI into Paris twenty-five years earlier, the *échevins* decided that 18 actors costumed as the Nine Worthies of both sexes should escort Marie as she passed from pageant to pageant through the town.⁵ The idea in general, of course, is simple. Costume some actors, put them on horses, and have them lead the procession, thus depicting the Duchess herself as a kind of tenth Worthy. But after all, how do you know a Worthy when you see one? The *échevins*' solution to this problem was to launch a program of iconographical research—or at least it would be called that if they were modern art historians. They thus dispatched two emissaries, Regnault de la Forest and Philippe du Pont, to visit the Duke of Bourbon's castle in Molins where they were instructed

pour veoir et rapporter par escript á la tapisserie de Monseigneur de Borbon les ix preux et ix preuses comme ilz estoient par ordre á ladite tapisserie, pour iceulx faire á ladite venue de Madame.

to view and describe in writing monseigneur de Bourbon's tapestry of the nine *preux* and nine *preuses* as they are set out in the said tapestry, in order to make these for the said coming of Madame.

Indeed, they regarded the Duke's tapestries as so authoritative that they sent de la Forest and du Point a second time to gather yet more information.

Getting the headdresses of the female Worthies right seems to have been a particular concern. De la Forest and other emissaries procured quantities of *or clinquant* (gold foil), *fil d'achal* (brass thread), leaves of *rogecler* (an expensive red enamel), and *filet* (net) and delivered them to two *ouvriers* (tiremakers perhaps?) of Molins, whom they commissioned on behalf of the *échevins* to fashion 'the *habillemans de teste* of the said *preuses*'. Then there was the matter of the *targes* (shields) with their correct heraldic blazons. Details of the *habits de hosseures de chevaux* (elaborately decorated horse caparisons) were also carefully noted, and they copied down the *escripteaux*

and *histoires of desdits preux et preuses* from the tapestries. These latter were then given to Jehan du Brueil, *escripvain*, to be copied out and attached to each of the Worthies' costumes, much as the figures in the Duke's tapestries would have been identified by such scriptures.⁶

The process by which an idea was turned into a spectacle may seem awkward, even counterintuitive to us. First of all, the idea for the spectacle was almost certainly one of the many written accounts of the Entry of Henry VI into Paris escorted by the nine *preux* and nine *preuses*. It had been twenty-five years since that event, and even if a living memory may have still lingered in one or two witnesses, such recollections could not have been very helpful. The *échevins*, after all, decided that they needed to send emissaries to Moulins to consult the Duke's tapestries so that they would have authoritative visual models. But in sending them, they specifically asked for de la Forest and Dupont to see (*veoir*) the tapestries and then return and *rapporter par escript*. Consider the words, *rapporter par escript*. The *échevins* do not seem to have been much interested in sketches; they specifically commissioned a written, verbal report.⁷ On the basis of this written report the tiremakers, painters, and clothworkers were set to work fashioning headdresses, caparisons, coats of arms, and so forth. Neither the *échevins* as a body nor the two emissaries were skilled craftsmen who might actually make all these objects, so in the end, the written report of the tapestries was subject to the interpretation of the individual craftsmen who had probably not seen the tapestries themselves.

To me, at least, these elaborate arrangements suggest much about the ways that civic councillors, visual artists, writers, and various craftsmen cooperated in the planning and production of an elaborate Royal Entry spectacle. This is spectacle by committee, and the *échevins*, rather than any single artistic personality, are firmly in charge both of the process, and of course, of the purse strings. A rather large group of craftsmen, artists, scribes were both supervised by the councillors, and yet also allowed a respectful leeway in performing their own offices. They often work from written descriptions, but in the end they create spectacle. Often it is difficult to say who 'designed' the spectacle because the design functions are parcelled out amongst all these people. And yet the spectacle is as often as not sophisticated in its final form.⁸

One of the surprising features of this process is that written descriptions, rather than artist's sketches, are usually the primary document for designing and controlling production. Especially where there is a great deal of central control, the design process often begins with a committee meeting at which a

written *device* is drawn up by a group of men who meet under the aegis of the town council. It will always include councillors, but it may also include writers and clerics and perhaps even an artist. Their job is to decide the subjects of the pageants that are to be constructed for the Entry and to compile an authoritative description of these proposed pageants. This document, usually called a *device*, is intended be the primary means for monitoring the progress of construction and production. The job of those who are placed on the committee for their literary, scholarly, or clerical talents will be to suggest the biblical, liturgical, classical, historical, or mythological topics of each pageant and to devise appropriate 'scriptures' to be written or posted on the pageant. Occasionally, an artist will be asked to join the committee; if so, his job will be to make preliminary sketches of what it is that the committee has decided. This document will be scrutinized and approved, of course, by the town council, who will want to know how much it costs, but it will also be read by those who are constructing the individual pageants, and it will as a matter of course be translated — not merely replicated — into carpentry, heraldry, painting, costumes, and so forth. It may also be scrutinized and approved by councillors or other representatives of the person making his or her Entry into the city. There can be very few secrets when constructing such a large-scale spectacle in the major thoroughfares of the town. Finally, the same document may also be used as the basis for a formal literary memorial of the event. The writer or poet who composes this account, however, may not have witnessed more than a part of the actual spectacle, or none at all, and he may have had nothing whatsoever to do with planning and executing the actual spectacle.

We find records of such documents being generated throughout Western Europe. One example, found among the records of the Bruges Entry of the Archduke Charles (1515), can serve as typical; it should help us to understand how all the texts we shall shortly be considering were generated and used. And we shall also return to another record of the same type at the end of our investigation to help us understand how one important artist's work can be understood as contributing to this process.

Once the decision had been made to stage a Royal Entry for the Archduke Charles, the Bruges civic council appointed a committee of six rhetoricians to plan the Entry. This group met at an inn named 'The Blind Ass' near the Town Hall, where they drew up a list of pageant *devices* over dinner. They made plans for eleven *devices* illustrating 'the history of the foundation, rise, and decline' of Bruges.⁹ This list of eleven proposed pageants was meant to be the backbone of the show; pageants from this list

would begin and end the show, and appear at intervals throughout. However, sixteen other pageants were also to be contributed by the town's varied communities of foreign merchants: Aragonese, Hanseatic, Spanish, Italian, and the Seigneurs du Franc. Since these groups were planning their own contributions, the town's committee sought to bring coherence to the whole by creating a structured sequence of spectacles illustrating the history of Bruges that would provide a memorable and defining context for the whole.

A group of six rhetoricians — members of the city's Chambers of Rhetoric — formed the heart of the committee who devised the list of pageant topics.¹⁰ At this stage, the committee would have produced the written *device* that described the subjects and essential features of each pageant, and it may also have included the *scriptures* that were to be written upon each tableau. Once this document had been agreed upon, it could then be given to an artist, in this case a certain Willem d'Hollandre, who was paid for making '11 *patroonen* of the pageants'.¹¹ D'Hollandre's job was thus to translate the verbal *device* into a series of visual sketches, then conventionally called *patrons*, one for each of the eleven proposed pageants. These two documents — written *devices* and visual *patrons* — are then passed on to the carpenters and painters who are hired to construct the pageants. Jan Fabiaen and his fellow painters are thus charged to perform their labours 'according to the information displayed in the *patroone* and the declaration provided to them'.¹² In addition, it is important to note here that after drawing up the eleven *patroonen* of the eleven *tooghen*, d'Hollandre seems to have had no further role to play in the production of the Royal Entry. It was left to the painters and carpenters to interpret his sketches, all the while reading them in conjunction with the written *declaration* or *device*. If anything, the written declaration was the definitive document; the *patroonen* were sketches that helped one to visualize the arrangement of the features referred to in the *device*.

In addition to these two types of documents, another more comprehensive class of documents was also commonly produced on these occasions: summary narrative accounts of the Royal Entry. These are of two kinds. On the one hand, 'official' accounts are often composed under the aegis of the town who staged the Entry. On the other hand, individual chroniclers, poets, and other writers often contribute unofficial accounts based on what they have seen or according to information they have independently gathered from a variety of sources.

The official accounts are usually composed by professional writers, court poets, or civic historians, and they contain considerable information, including extensive descriptions of the pageantry and sometimes visual renderings of the pageants as well. The writers of these tracts may or may not have played a role in the devising of the pageants. Remy Du Puys, who compiled the official account of the Bruges Entry, *La tryumphante Entree de Charles prince des Espagnes en Bruges 1515*, for instance, was merely the official historian; he was not one of the rhetoricians who met at the Blind Ass, and his text makes clear that he played no role whatsoever in devising the pageants.¹³ In much the same way, as we shall see, the poet Lydgate was given materials by the devisers of the show to help him write an official account of the Entry of Henry VI into London, but he did not ‘devise’ the pageants, as is often claimed. Whether or not such writers played some part in the devising of these spectacles, however, these accounts usually have access to many sources of information that mere observers do not. Because they are composing official accounts, however, they necessarily betray obvious ‘pro-establishment’ biases. These are not objective reports so much as a species of civic encomium.

The reports contributed by various unofficial writers are almost always brief, and they will usually be limited in two important ways. First, they will often be limited by the inability of the writer to see the entire show. Royal Entries are crowded spectacles, and towns understandably are eager to keep these shows orderly by limiting the movements of spectators. Secondly, they are limited by the writers’ own biases and abilities to understand the often allegorical meanings of the spectacles that they do manage to see. One needs only to read the very different eyewitness accounts of the Entry of Mary Stuart into Edinburgh in 1561 to see how dramatically the viewer’s religious sympathies can deeply affect what each sees and reports.¹⁴ But these narratives often provide valuable information to supplement the official accounts, and in most cases, they may be the only accounts we have.

One might think of the first two documents — the verbal *device* and visual *patron* — as relatively ephemeral texts. Some have survived however. Perhaps *devices* have survived more often than *patrons*. Because there is no standard format for such *devices*, and because they are often found embedded in other texts, they have not been much recognized as a genre. We shall here consider several of them to give ourselves a good idea of what they seek to accomplish, and we shall also examine some further records that refer to their use. We will also examine a very few *patrons*, although only one of these can be regarded as an original document drawn up by the artist; a few

others will be offered tentatively and speculatively. Here I want to examine five such documents. Three are *devices* as created by a committee, one is a report of the deliberations of a civic committee as it draws up a pageant *device* and commissioned an artist to prepare *patrons*, and the fifth is a well-known *patron*.

1. The London Entry of Henry VI (1432): *Device* and Official Commemorative Account

The poet John Lydgate is often described as the ‘deviser’ of the coronation Entry of Henry VI into London on 21 February 1432, but this is not so. As H. N. MacCracken pointed out a century ago, Lydgate merely described what was communicated to him in a letter by the Town Clerk of London, John Carpenter.¹⁵ What has not been fully grasped, however, is that Carpenter’s letter contains the document as hammered out in what must have been a committee charged by the Court of Aldermen to devise a plan for the civic pageants. As the Town Clerk, it would have been Carpenter’s job to draw up the finished document that resulted from these deliberations, and hence he could readily send a version of that document to Lydgate. The purpose of his communication with Lydgate, moreover, is quite straightforward. Although Lydgate had nothing to do with planning the event, he was being commissioned to perform ‘poet’s work’. His job was to take the *device* and use it to compose a poem to celebrate and memorialize a grand event.¹⁶ By sending the city’s *device* to Lydgate, Carpenter thereby provided the poet with an authoritative and convenient source of information to be used in the composition of the celebratory poem. These two documents thus give us a rare view of the beginning and end of the spectacle-making process, and by comparing them, we can perhaps tell something about the middle parts as well.

The text of the committee’s *device* as preserved in Carpenter’s letter is actually quite detailed, and it contains a plan for a very learned, theologically-informed pageant series. It gives a verbal description of each pageant to be constructed, and it lists as well the scriptures that must be painted on it to explain the scene. On the whole these are self-consciously learned and biblical in nature, and they tell us that the committee included literate, almost certainly clerical, men among its membership. Carpenter was one of these; he was a lay brother of the convent of the Charterhouse in London, and he cultivated the literate and powerful. He was on friendly terms with Lord Mayors and poets alike. But he would not have been the sole ‘deviser’ of this document. Carpenter thus makes no personal claim of

authorship. He certainly contributed to the plan, but it is nevertheless committee work.

Carpenter's account of the pageant planned for Cheapside gives us a good idea of what such a document does and does not include. Above the Great Conduit (*super magnum aqueductum*), the King was to see:

amœnissimum et pulcherrimum locum ad modum Paradisi consitum, stellatum floribus, et arboribus fructiforis relucens, et breviter omnium rerum speciositate conspicuum; ex cujus latere Aquilonis in civitatem Regis magni fontes vivacissimi scaturiebant aquas architriclinas in vinum conversas, qui gustus regios post tantam virtutum adoptionem merito poterant recreare.

*In hoc insuper loco illi duo prædestinati cives sanctorum et domestici Dei, Ennok, scilicet, et Ely, congratulantes de tanti Regis adventu, portantis pacem, illuminantis propriam, et dantis pacem gentibus, et, quasi desiderantes et expectantes ipsum futurum canonem et consortem suum, pro statu suo prospero precabantur, unus, vicelicet, quod Nihil proficiat inimicus in eo, nec filius iniquitatis apponat nocere ei, et alter quod Dominus conservet eum, et vivificet eum, et beatum faciet eum in terra, et non tradat illum in manus inimicorum ejus. Circa vero fontes illos cuilibet litterarum oraculis incitabatur ad hauriendum aquas in gaudio de fontibus Salvatoris.*¹⁷

a most pleasant and most beautiful garden planted in the manner of Paradise, starred with flowers and shining with fruit-bearing trees and, in short, attracting the attention with every kind of beauty, from whose north side in the city of the king, great and most vigorous fountains gushed architriclinian waters transformed into wine which, having taken on such great powers, might justly refresh the royal taste.

In this place, moreover, these two predestined fellow-citizens of the saints and household servants of God, to wit Enoch and Elijah, rejoicing together at the advent of so great a king, [who was] bearing a light, casting lustre on his own, and bestowing peace on the people; and as if desiring and longing for him to be their colleague and partner, they prayed that his state should be prosperous: the one, to wit, that 'the enemy shall have no advantage over him, nor the son of iniquity have power to hurt him', and the other that 'the Lord preserve him and give him life, and make him blessed upon the earth, and deliver him not up to the will of his enemies'. And, indeed,

around those fountains there was a pressing invitation in written utterances to anyone and everyone 'to draw waters with joy out of the Saviour's fountains'.

This passage — only one representative sample of seven such passages — tells us a great deal about how the planners envisioned this pageant. First, they did not anticipate that any of the characters on the pageant would formally address the king or even speak to one another. The scriptures were to be posted on the pageant to identify the characters and to serve *in place of* speech. This is in fact standard throughout Europe in the fifteenth century. The devisers envisioned these pageants as especially vivid works of art, not as 'dramas' *per se*. Theatre happened when the king approached the spectacle and became part of the spectacle. The crowd was to play a part as well by shouting acclamations — whether merely 'hurrah' or, as some chroniclers would have it, something more portentous like *benedictus qui venit in nomine domine* or even *noel, noel*.¹⁸ These shouts of acclamation were what the show aimed at, a hopeful sign both of popular recognition of the new king and acceptance. The consequences of this expectation, however, meant that while singing might usefully be employed, speech couldn't be expected to work very well. It was too noisy.¹⁹

The *device* sketches out the essential details of the proposed pageant: a star-strewn Paradise was to be constructed atop the Conduit and filled with fruit-bearing trees. The conduit itself was to be employed as the fountain of Paradise. Imitating Jesus' miracle at Cana, the water in the Conduit must miraculously turn to wine, and all will be invited to drink from it. Next, the *device* specifies only two necessary characters, Enoch and Elijah, who must stand in this pageant Paradise to greet the King. Finally, the *device* specifies three *scriptures*: Psalm 88: 23 ('The enemy shall have no advantage over him, nor the son of iniquity have power to hurt him'), Psalm 40: 3 ('The Lord preserve him and give him life, and make him blessed upon the earth, and deliver him not up to the will of his enemies'), and Isaiah 12: 3 ('You shall draw waters with joy out of the Saviour's fountains').²⁰ These not only form the bases of the pageant's religious allegory, but they must also be written on placards and posted on it.

Since MacCracken has already demonstrated how closely Lydgate followed this passage in composing his poem (the phrase *aquas architriclinas*, for instance, becomes 'lyke to the water off Archedeclyne' in Lydgate's poem), it is not necessary to repeat that exercise here.²¹ As in his descriptions of all the other pageants, Lydgate faithfully translated the details and phraseology of the relevant passage of Carpenter's letter into English

rhyme-royal stanzas, and he transcribes the scriptures into the margins of his own manuscript at the appropriate points. As MacCracken points out, however, Lydgate's description at this point departs from this usual practice. For the first and only time in the poem, he adds considerable descriptive material not present in Carpenter's letter. If we examine these additions, we will find that they reveal a great deal about how the makers of the pageants pursued their own independent acts of devising on this collaborative project.

Lydgate's account of this pageant introduces three entirely new characters — Mercy, Grace, and Pity — not specified in Carpenter's *device*. According to Lydgate, these three 'virgyns' stood at the well and 'drew wyne vp off ioye and off pleasaunce'. Mercy 'mynystred' wines of Temperance, Grace 'shedde' liquor of Good Governance, and Pity 'profered' wines of Comfort and Consolation.²² Nowhere else in the poem does he add to the cast of characters as specified in Carpenter's letter. That he does so here suggests that he may be uniquely reporting what he has actually seen, not merely versifying a Latin text.

I would suggest that Lydgate's addition here captures an important detail that was added by those who were in charge of constructing the pageant and staffing it with actors. It is important here to realize that the text of the original *device* as hammered out in committee was in no way comprehensive. Carpenter's letter thus specified all of the iconographical material, the characters, and the scriptures that *must* feature in the finished pageant, but it also leaves much to the imagination of the artisans who would actually build the pageant and act in it. The *device*, in other words, specifies the minimum necessary detail and expects that the makers will interpret it in their own individual ways. In particular, the pageant makers here seem to have been troubled by the problem of distributing wine to all who wished to drink. Might this liberal gift of alcohol perhaps cause a dangerous and disorderly scramble? To solve this problem, they invented an orderly distribution system. Three maidens could control (and hence limit) the distribution by drawing the wine from the conduit and offering it to the crowd. At the same time, the presence of these three allegorical maidens offered the possibility of an especially ceremonial presentation of a cup of wine to the King and to the members of his party when they reached the Conduit. It only remained to give them, and the wine they distributed, an appropriately allegorical significance modelled upon the allegory of Frère Lorens's *Somme le roi*.²³

Every one of the pageants, of course, must have involved similar acts of inventive devising resulting in considerable (and expected) departures from

the committee's *device*. Why does Lydgate ignore such departures in his descriptions of every other pageant except this one? The answer, I think, is that Lydgate did not actually see any of the other pageants. He viewed the King's Entry from a vantage point opposite the Great Conduit on that February day and could not view any of the other pageants. He probably could not have moved through the enforced order of the crowded London streets on that day to view the performances at other pageants even if he had wanted to do so. As a consequence, if Lydgate was to fulfil his commission to devise a successful poem commemorating the event, he needed a written description which could provide him with adequate details of the pageants that he could not personally witness. Because of this departure from the *device* supplied to him by Carpenter, however, we have something very rare in Lydgate's poem. We can not only tell that Lydgate actually was present to witness part of the show he described, but we can also identify, with some assurance, the exact place that he stood to witness the event.

2. The London Entry of Henry VIII and Charles V (1522): The Minimal *Device*

Because the 1432 pageant plan was so theologically orientated, its *device* was necessarily full of details that prescribed the essential allegorical content that the pageants must contain. The *device* for the Entry of Henry VIII and Charles V aims at the opposite extreme: it prescribes little more than the subject matter of each pageant. The London committee's *device* or master plan for the 1522 joint Entry of Henry VIII and the Emperor Charles V has remarkably survived, albeit in the form of an eighteenth-century printed transcription of a manuscript now destroyed.²⁴ In comparison with the descriptions of pageants to be constructed in Carpenter's letter, this list of *devices* thus seems laconic in the extreme. Instead of the wealth of biblical and allegorical material, the items in the committee's list contains few details: 'Upon the Draw-bridge shall be one Pageant of *Jason* with the Golden Fleece; because the Emperor giveth the Golden Fleece, as the King of *England* doth give the Garter. Also there shall be set, in the Likeness of the Emperor, and all the Kings that hold of the Emperor, with Crowns on their heads'. The committee's plan for the pageant at the Conduit in Cheap especially pales in comparison with the richly detailed description of the 1432 pageant erected in the same place: 'Also at the Conduit in the *Cheap* shall be the Assumption of our Lady, as goodly as can be wrought, &c. Angels, Archangells, Patriarchs, Prophets, with the Apostles in the heavenlyest Manner. The Sun, the Moon, with the Starrs shining bright, which shall open and bow

down to the Honour of Our Lady, with Voices of young Choristers, the which shall sing most sweetly, as may be devised by Musick'.²⁵ These are not concrete plans so much as suggestions to the builders ('as goodly as can be wrought, &c') and musicians ('as may be devised by Musick').

Such minimal descriptions obviously expect the actual constructors of the pageants to flesh them out and give them substance. To some extent, indeed, the Guilds who financed and constructed the pageants seem to have been able to choose one of the topics from the Committee's list that most struck their fancies. When the Aldermen pressured the 'marchauntes Italyons' to make one of the pageants at their own 'Costes & Charges', their leader, Antony Vyvald, picked 'the Pagent of the Duke of Lancastre to stand at Ledyn Hall' from off the list.²⁶

We should not be surprised, then, to find that actual descriptions of the finished structures show considerable divergences from the plans, ones, moreover, that could not have been anticipated by the committee members who drew up this initial plan. Take the Draw-Bridge pageant of 'Jason with the Golden Fleece' which was clearly intended by the committee planners to focus upon Charles as Sovereign of the *Toison d'Or*; 'because the Emperor giveth the Golden Fleece, as the King of *England* doth give the Garter'. As expected, Jason appears 'all in harneys, hauyng before hym a golden Flece'. Visually, however, the Argonaut seems to get lost in an attention-catching pyrotechnical display. To one side of Jason, they placed a 'fiery Dragon' and to the other 'two Bulles whiche beastes cast out fyer continually'. Jason, of course, had to master these monsters to win the Fleece; he had first to hitch the bulls to a plough to prepare the ground, then he had to extract the dragon's teeth and plant them. But, as the pageant reminds us, he was able to do these things only because Medea, the enchantress, aided and protected him. Hence, the pageant makers set Medea 'very straungely and rychely appareled' to preside over the scene from the top of a tower. She, rather than Jason, seems to be in control of the scene. If Edward Hall, who witnessed this scene, was typical in finding his eyes drawn to the fire-spewing dragon and bulls and to Medea's strange and rich costume, then it might well be argued that Medea and her sorcery were more central to the pageant than Jason's heroism. Certainly the Fleece's connection to the *Toison d'or* — which is what the committee clearly had in mind — was overwhelmed by the pageant-maker's interest in constructing a riveting spectacular display.²⁷

While most of the pageants listed on the Committee plan do little more than specify general subject matter, one of the proposed pageant-devices

stands out from the rest as being very specific indeed in what it envisions. At the Conduit in the Stocks, the Committee decreed,

there shall be made one Castle and an Orchard, and one Garden made by a vice [i.e. machinery], and shall be with Birds singing upon Trees, and divers manner of wild Beasts, and Motes with Sluices, with Fishes swimming in them. And out of two Ports of the Corners shall come two Men, one like the King, another like the Emperor, having two Swords in their Hands, clean armed, and shall meet and kiss, and the Father of Heaven being over their Heads, blessing them.

Unlike the rather bland and general descriptions for a conventional pageant subject such as 'Jason and the Golden Fleece' or 'The Assumption of our Lady', this refers to a particular and fully-realized design that had been worked out *before* putting it in the Committee plan.

We need only compare it with a description of the finished pageant to see how this item refers to a very individual — even idiosyncratic — visual display. The 'Ile off englonde', according to the contemporary report, was 'compassede all abowte *with* water made in siluer and byc lyke to waves off the see'. The isle itself contained 'champion countrey',

mountayns and woodys where were dyuers bestes goyng abowte the mountayns by vyces and dyuers maner off trees herbys and flowres ... so craftely made thatt hit was harde to knowe them from very naturall flowres and in the mountayns pondys off fressh water *with* fisshe. And att the commyng off the emprow the bestys dyd move and goo the fisshes dyd sprynge the byrdes dyd synge reioysyng the commyng off the ij princes the emprow and the kynges grace. Also ther were ij goodly ymages one in a castell lyke to the emprow in visage and the other in an herbar wyth rosys lyke to the kynges grace wyth ij swerdys nakyd in ther handys whiche castell garden and the ymages dyd ryse by a vyce. The ymages dyd beholde eche other and then cast away ther swerdys by a vyce and *with* another vyce ioyned eche to other and embrasede eche other in tokennyng off love and pease. Whiche don an ymage off the fater off hevyn all in burnyd golde dyd disclose and appere and move in the topp off the pageant wyth this scripture wrytyn abowte hym. *Beati pacifici qui filij dei vocabuntur.*²⁸

The finished pageant, thus, includes almost nothing that was not anticipated in some detail in the Committee's list of *devices*.

We can account for the difference in this case because we know who the pageant maker was and we get a brief glimpse of his interactions with the committee. The playwright and theatrical entrepreneur, John Rastell, devised this spectacular pageant. He seems to have brought his proposal to the Committee when it was at the point of drawing up the plan. Rastell's proposal, indeed, worried the Committee a good deal. With all of its machinery, it seemed very expensive to construct. So Rastell had to pitch his idea to the Court of Aldermen, and they approved it provided that it would cost no more than fifteen pounds.²⁹

Perhaps the clearest example of the pageant committee's relative indifference to exerting tight control over the pageant images and their meanings can be seen in another of the provisions. As we have seen, the pageant committee on this occasion did not trouble to specify the explanatory *scriptures* that were customarily posted on the pageants. This was perhaps a primary concern of Henry VI's pageant planners in 1432, but on this occasion, the committee seems to have regarded the *scriptures* with some indifference. What they did was to commission the scholar and poet, William Lily, to compose something suitable that might bring some order to a patently miscellaneous series of pageant topics. Lily clearly saw his job as independent of the efforts of the pageant builders. He seems not to have actually checked on whether the verses he wrote were very appropriate to the pageants as actually constructed. His major reference seems to have been the list of pageant topics that we have been considering.

For the most part, he attempted to produce verses that struck the ear as impressive but which were general enough to avoid conflicts with whatever visual matter the pageant builders eventually produced. He began by formulating a single, generic scripture that could be emblazoned 'in letters of golde / and set vp at the crosse in chepe / and at euery pagiant:'

*Carolus Henricus uiuant. Defensor uterque
Henricus Fidei. Carolus Ecclesiae.*

Long live Charles and Henry, each of them the Defender,
Henry of the Faith, Charles of the Church.

Supposedly to explain what the King and the Emperor were seeing, Lily then composed several lines of Latin verse for each pageant. In fact, however, these verses explained very little. His verse for the London Bridge pageant of 'Jason and the Golden Fleece', for instance, barely makes connection with the visual iconography of the pageant:

*Letitiæ quantum Minyis præbebat Iason,
Aurea Phryxæ uellera nactus Ouis,
Letitiæ quantum tulerat Pompeius, et urbi,
Hoste triumphato, Scipio Romulidum.
Tantum tu nobis, Cæsar mitissime princeps,
Intrans Henrici principis hospitium.*

What great ioye was it to the people of Mynis?
What tyme the highe renowned knight Iason
Had conquered in Colchos / the golden flis:
What ioye eke was / the tryumphe of Scipion?
And of hym Pompey / to the romayns echone
Lyke ioye to vs Charles / prince of Clemency
Is at thy comyng / with pusaunt kyng Henry. ³⁰

Lily's verse clearly assumes that the pageant will primarily be about Jason as the hero who won the Golden Fleece because that is all that the committee's list of pageant *devices* had specified. He could not have anticipated that the pageant builders would make Medea central to the show, nor that they would indulge themselves in a pyrotechnic display.

The very lack of detailed specifications in the list of pageant *devices* probably best explains the vagueness of Lily's verses. The poet simply could not tell from that list whether the various pageants would employ actors or *images* (sculpted and painted figures) to represent Arthur, Charlemagne, Henry VIII, Charles V, and all of the other characters. As a consequence, he designed his verse to be general enough so that it would suit whatever specific design the carpenters might produce. The verse's lack of connection with the visual iconography is thus not so much a mark of failure as an intended consequence of the genre in which Lily was writing. To modern tastes, his verse may seem pompous and empty, but pomp, after all, was what he was striving for; from his point of view his verse was not empty so much as artfully generalized.³¹

All of this activity suggests a good deal of independence among cooperating artisans. Although there is a good deal of anxiety about containing costs, the committee who composed the original list of devices expected that the builders would have considerable leeway in constructing the pageants. Obviously, the committee who set out its plans for the Entry of Henry VI had a much more specific idea about what the pageants should look like than did those who planned the Entry of Henry VIII and Charles V almost a century later. Those who planned the 1522 Entry probably had no

specific design in mind and were happy to leave the finished product to the builders. Greater or lesser degrees of control might thus be exercised centrally upon the pageant images and their meaning, but there is always an expectation that the plans will be not merely realized by the builders, but interpreted by them.

3. The Entry of François I^{er} into Poitiers (1520): The Embedded *Device*

The redoubtable Jean Bouchet is sometime described as the *ordonnateur* of the pageants for the Poitiers Entry of François I, but the evidence for this hypothesis is circumstantial at best. Because Bouchet was a notable organizer and supervisor of *mystères*, and because he describes the Poitiers Royal Entry pageants in his *Annales d'Aquitaine*, it follows that he must have also supervised this Entry as well, and if he organized it, then he must also have devised the pageantry for the event. However, as Jennifer Britnell observes, 'Bouchet himself never mentions that he had any part in organizing one'.³² We can, perhaps, throw some light on this puzzle if we examine Bouchet's text.

Bouchet's description of the King's Entry into Poitiers is remarkable for two features. First, the description of the Entry itself is almost non-existent. At the beginning, Bouchet merely records the bare fact that 'the King made his Entry into the said town of Poitiers, about six o'clock at night, with torchlight: where were the Queen, and madam Regent, mother of the King, and the following triumphs were performed for them'.³³ Then after the three pageants have been described in some detail, Bouchet merely tells us that the King dined at the Chateau de Dissay, and recounts what happened there. Remarkably, there is no account whatsoever about the King's actual Entry. We cannot tell from the description of the pageants, for instance, whether the King paused before them, whether a child may have addressed the King, whether the crowd shouted acclamations of some kind, whether the King waved, gestured, or made a remark of any kind. There is not so much as a mention of others riding in procession with him. Whatever else this passage may be, it is not a chronicle.

The descriptions of the three pageants, by contrast, are richly detailed, but they do not form a narrative. Bouchet only includes pageant details; he does not relate the pageant in performance. The first pageant, he thus tells us, was placed at the porte saint Ladre:

En face y auoit vn haut eschaffault, tout decoré de verdure naturelle, par artifice d'Italie, & diuises de peinture a l'anticque: sur lequel eschaffault y auoit a main dextre, vn grand homme nommé Poitiers, vestu sobrement, selon l'ancien temps, qui tenoit en sa main vng escripteau, auquel estoit escript: Egredimini, & vidite Regem in diademate. Canti. Iij. Chap. Et sur ledit personnage estoit escript en vers

*Je suis Poitiers, c'est a dire, esprit coy,
Qui le mien nom change & diuersifie:
Si ie suis paouure, & n'ay gramment dequoy,
L'ay bon vouloir, de ce me glorifie:
Ma langue est grosse, & ne me magnifie
En mon auoir, esprit, scauoir, science,
Et suis tousiours, aucun ne s'en defie,
Paoure & loyal, & plain de patience.*

Opposite there was a high scaffold, decorated all over with natural green foliage, in the Italian style, and with painted designs in the classical manner. On the right-hand side of the scaffold, a tall man called Poitiers, dressed soberly in the antique fashion, held a *scripture* in his hand, on which was written, 'Come and see the King in his diadem' (Song of Songs 3: 11). And above the said personage was written in verse:

I am Poitiers, that is to say, a humble spirit,
Who changes and varies my name;
If I am poor, and do not have a great deal of anything,
I mean well, I can boast of that,
My speech is coarse, and I do not pride myself
In my possessions, wit, knowledge, learning;
And I am always, no-one can gainsay it,
Poor and loyal, and long-suffering.

Similar detailed descriptions of the features of the pageant follow: upon a pillar were inscribed two other *scriptures* based closely on Canticles: *veni dilecte mi[hi] commoremur in villis. Cant. Vij* ('Come, my beloved, let us abide in the villages'; 7:11) and *inueni quem diligit anima mea. Cant. iij.* ('I found him whom my soul loveth'; 3:4). Then there was a very natural-looking stag crowned with gold and holding between his horns the arms of France. A young girl sat in the middle of the scaffold, wearing a gold crown on her brow and a gown of blue taffeta sprinkled with golden *fleurs de lis*. Seated upon the *chaire de Paix*, she leaned her head upon her arms and slept.

Another *scripture* drawn from Canticles 2:7 was posted upon her throne: *Adiuro vos filiae, per cervos camporum, ne suscitetis & evigilare faciatis dilectam, donec ipsa velit* ('I adjure you, O ye daughters [of Jerusalem], by the stags of the fields, that you do not rouse and awake my love, till she pleases'). Ten young girls were placed on a smaller scaffold a little lower than the main display. They were dressed in taffeta gowns of ten different colours and represented 'ten Christian nations': Sicily, Rome, Italy, Lombardy, Germany, Austria, Switzerland, England, Spain, and Hungary. Upon either side of this *tableau* were posted two scriptures from Ecclesiasticus: *Respicite filij nationes hominum* ('My children behold the generations [nations] of men'; 2:11) and *Natio illorum, obedientia et dilectio* ('Their generation [nation], obedience and love'; 3:1). Finally, a *scripture* in the form of eight lines of French verse was posted between the two scaffolds to explain the general sense of the allegory: the watchful Cerf represents the King, and the girl in the Throne represents the peaceful slumber of France while the ten Christian nations remain at Peace.

This text is thus both detailed in terms of its descriptions of the pageant's characters and construction, but it is remarkably undetailed in terms of performance. Few observers would copy down all these details so minutely and also fail to record the actual encounter of King and pageant. What exactly is the nature of this description? What is its genre?

If we compare it with Carpenter's letter, I think we can see that what we are reading here closely resembles a detailed plan for constructing the pageantry; this is a *device*, not a report. It contains exactly what we would expect from a proposed and accepted plan for pageantry. It gives us details of the allegorical characters and essential properties (the sleeping maiden, the throne of Peace), and it specifies exactly what *scriptures* are to be posted on the pageant. These are what one might call the standard criteria that define the genre of the pageant report. Even the document's occasional vaguenesses support this generic view. What are the ten colours of the ten gowns that the ten women wear on the lower scaffold? What *diuises de peinture à la antique* decorate the pageant? What *artifice d'Italie* does Bouchet have in mind? In a description so circumstantial, such vague details strike one as out of character. Why mention them if they are not to be described? However, such specifications are exactly what one would expect to see in a pageant programme. The allegorical figures and the *scriptures* are the important things, but the plan would probably not specify these other details because they will be left to the discretion of the builders

and costumers: give us ten different colours to differentiate the ten Christian nations; make the details of the pageant look fashionably Italian.

Bouchet, I would suggest, has simply appropriated the town's pageant plan into his *Annales* to serve as an account of the King's arrival into Poitiers. The necessary modifications were minimal: all he needed to do was to alter the verb tenses. However, what this also means is that we cannot say with absolute certainty what the pageants looked like on the day of the Entry. We have to reckon with the inevitable alterations that would occur when the builders and actors actually constructed the pageants on the basis of this initial plan. About those alterations we know nothing.

What then does this document have to say about Bouchet superintending the preparations for the Entry? That he possessed the plan and worked it into his *Annales* tells us something. Not everyone has access to the town's planning document. Moreover, we can say that he actually composed such a document for an Entry at a different date. Bouchet was asked to superintend the preparations for the Entry of the Queen and Dauphin into Nantes in 1532. Although he did not actually travel to Nantes in person to supervise the production, he did draw up precisely this sort of document: *le devys des mysteres queulx seront faicts par les carrefours ès entrées de la royne et monseigneur le daulphin que a composés Bouschet* ('the device of the pageants which will be made at the crossroads for the Entries of the Queen and my lord the Dauphin which Bouchet composed').³⁴ This later essay in the pageant-device genre, moreover, was not the work of a committee. As the quotation cited above makes clear, the *devys* was composed by Bouchet alone. So too, I think, was the 1520 *devys*. The very literary nature of the Poitiers *devys* suggests that it probably was not a committee production, but that it must have been composed by a single writer and allegorist. Bouchet was both an allegorical writer and a chronicler; it was thus only natural that he would use his *devys* as copy for his chronicle. So one can say that he probably composed the plan for the three pageants on this occasion, and that his description of the Entry of François I^{er} into Poitiers in 1520 is merely a transcription of the *devys* that he drew up for that occasion.

4. The Proposed Entry of Louis XI into Tours (1461): Devisers and Artist

Except for the brief appearance of Willem d'Hollandre amongst the artisans preparing the Entry of the Archduke Charles into Bruges, artists have not

seemed to play much of a part in the devising of the Royal Entries we have examined. Indeed, it is not clear that preliminary sketches of pageants were thought of as especially crucial. When the councillors of Nevers sent two emissaries to the Duke of Bourbon's castle in Molins, after all, they were instructed to bring back written descriptions of the tapestry images, not sketches. A written *device*, such as Carpenter's letter or Bouchet's description, was probably sufficient for the guidance of most pageant builders. But artists were indeed often employed, and a few, unlike d'Hollandre, may even have served on the committees who drew up the original pageant *devices*. The Entry of Louis XI into Tours is one celebrated instance in which a very fine artist — Jean Fouquet — played an important role in the process of devising and building pageants, and the records of his interactions with the committee of pageant devisers is especially informative.

The Town Council of Tours learned, with some shock and consternation, of Louis XI's intentions to enter Tours on 17 August.³⁵ Initially, they took steps to commission a *harrangue* to welcome the king, marshal the *notables gens de ladite ville* to receive him in state, and to spruce up the streets and gates.³⁶ On 30 August the Council even considered a proposal to send a delegation to Amboise (where Louis was scheduled to make a state Entry before coming to Tours) to see how that town addressed these problems. What gift would the Amboisiens present to the Queen, they wondered, and what *mystères* would they stage during the King's formal Entry? Having decided that there was not enough time to send such an embassy and then make their own plans afterwards, however, they abandoned this suggestion.

From this point onward, three topics increasingly dominated their deliberations: the making of an expensive gift to be presented to the Queen; the provision for a royal *poësle* (canopy) to be carried over Louis as he entered the town, and the construction of *tableaux vivants* to be performed along the route of his march through the city. All three of these were thus 'artistic' matters, and eventually Fouquet was involved in two of these deliberations, and perhaps all three. We can watch the plans for these three artistic matters take increasingly concrete shape in the minutes of the Council meetings.

The Queen's gift, for instance, occasioned the most constant deliberation. On 30 August, the Council decided that they would have some *belle chose* made for the Queen.³⁷ Three weeks later (21 September), the *belle chose* had become an expensive and showy *nef de table*, a ceremonial, boat-shaped container for cutlery and condiments. On 23 September, the

Council called on the royal goldsmith, Gilbert Jehan, to tell him that they were thinking about giving the Queen a *nef* that might be valued at 500 or 600 *escuz d'or*. Jehan promised to consult with his *servitours* and report back to the council as to the *plus belle vesselle* that could be made for that price in the given time.

Plans for the *poësle* which would be carried above Louis XI's head during his Entry developed in much the same way. The Council first tabled the question of the colours and heraldic decoration of the canopy on 21 September, then two days later determined that it should be 'blue and the fringes white and red, and at the four corners there should be four angels who carry the escutcheon of the King'. As for the *tableaux*, the Council first wondered on 30 August whether Amboise would present *mistères* during the King's Entry there, then on 21 September it determined that 'there will be made four scaffolds at four crossroads for when the King will pass by, whereupon there will be made *mistères*', and it then reaffirmed this decision on 23 September.

These deliberations set the stage for Fouquet's appearance at the Council meeting of 25 September, where decisions as to the specific design of all three of these artistic matters were finally to be taken.³⁸ Gilbert Jehan, the king's goldsmith, thus arrived with a *patron* (sketch) of a proposed *nef de table*, to be made from gilded silver, as he had promised to do at the previous meeting. Fouquet was there, in the first instance, to discuss the specific design of the *poësle* and the materials from which it should be made. Since he would probably have been informed of the decision at the previous meeting that the canopy should be blue with a golden angel at each corner, he, like his colleague Gilbert Jehan, seems to have come to the Council meeting armed with a specific design in mind, although there is no mention of a sketch. Nevertheless, he was able to propose a good deal of decorative detail and to recommend someone who might actually make it. The canopy, he thought, should indeed be blue, made from white and red taffeta,³⁹ and then embroidered with a sun in the middle and strewn with fifty crowns. The fringes, he determined, should be gold, made specifically from gold cloth from *Lucques* [Lucca] in Italy. He then recommended that the council commission Jehan Belin, embroiderer, to buy the cloth and carry out the design to these specifications.

Finally, the Council turned to the design of the Royal Entry pageantry. Because nobody had yet come up with a *device* or plan for the four *tableaux*, the Council directed that a committee of five Councillors (Jehan Bernard, Jehan Ruzé, Pierre Lailier, Jehan Peslieu, and Jehan Garnier) should meet

'after dinner in the house of Master Jehan Bernard' where they should compose *divisez* (*devices*) for the *chafaux* (scaffolds) and *mistères* (*tableaux*). This committee of town councillors, not Fouquet, bore the principal responsibility for 'devising' the pageantry. In this sense, *devising* meant that they were to draw up a list of descriptions of the subjects of the *tableaux* like the one we examined above for the London Entry of Henry VI. Though not a Councillor himself, Fouquet was also invited to attend this meeting to draw sketches of the *devices* that the Councillors would propose.⁴⁰

This division of function is quite ordinary in the process of 'devising' during the late medieval and Early Modern period, as we have seen in the other examples discussed above: the Councillors 'devised' the pageants in the sense that they wrote up a list of descriptions of the pageant subjects, characters, and so forth. In drawing up such a list of *devices* for the pageantry, this committee of five Tours bourgeois thus went about their task in much the same way that committees in Bruges, or London, or Lyons can be shown to have done. As an artist, Fouquet was charged with making a *patron* or visual rendering of the proposed *device*. His job was roughly parallel to that of Willem d'Hollandre in the Bruges Entry of the Archduke Charles discussed above. In this sense, the Council itself had 'devised' the *nef de table* that they intended to give to the Queen, then turned the matter over to the artisan, Gilbert Jehan, who drew up a visual *patron* of the proposed *device*.

As an artist attached to the Tours committee of 1461, Fouquet's job was thus distinct from that of the other committee members. He may well have offered some suggestions as to pageant topics, but as the language of the relevant Tours documents show, his presence on that committee was primarily to turn the committee's verbal *devices* into visual sketches: the Committee called upon Fouquet 'to draw their [the committee's] device'.⁴¹ This, as we have seen, was a valued and traditional role for an artist to play in the preparation of a Royal Entry.

Such visual sketches of *tableaux vivants* for Royal Entries were thus often seen to be 'painters' work', analogous to their designs and executions of panel paintings and miniatures and employing very similar painterly techniques of representation. Almost all of the most important painters of Fouquet's era — Robert Campin, Jean Perréal, Jehan Prévost, Jehan Poyet, Hans Holbein, Pierre Gringoire among them — were commissioned to make such sketches for Royal Entries. There is absolutely no evidence for supposing that Fouquet's activities as a 'designer' of the Royal Entry extended beyond the drawing of these sketches. We must not imagine that the artist might

have busied himself in overseeing the actual construction of the pageants or painting the scaffolds.

Fouquet apparently did complete a set of sketches based upon the *devices* that the members of the committee drew up after dinner at the house of Master Jehan Bernard. On 31 October, Fouquet appeared once again before the Council, and he apparently brought with him the sketches of the committee's *devices*.⁴² We must not imagine that these sketches would have been quickly dashed off or that he did the work singlehandedly. When Fouquet arrived at the 31 October council meeting, he was accompanied by two other artists who had assisted him in the preparation of his sketches: Pierre Hannes and Symon Chouain.⁴³ Probably a number of sketches of each *tableau* were required to visualize not only an overview of each pageant (as we will see in the Holbein sketch), but also significant details to be fabricated by carpenters, and much of this detailed work could be assigned to assistants as was Fouquet's normal practice as the master of an atelier. In any case, the council paid handsomely for the *paines* and *salaires* ('labours and wages').⁴⁴ All three of these matters — a painted canopy, a silver *nef*, and sketches for Royal Entry pageantry — reflect the normal activities of a successful artist in the late Middle Ages and the Early Modern period.

Fouquet himself is known not only to have painted panel and manuscript paintings, but also to have designed 'objects': a tapestry design, a death mask for Charles VII, a design for stained glass, medallions, a design for the tomb of Louis XI, and painted canopies for royal entries.⁴⁵ Most of this work has been lost, of course, but the range of Fouquet's total output might well have resembled that of Holbein's: panel paintings, manuscript decoration, silver sculptures, and a variety of other objects. Fouquet's sketches for the Royal Entry of 1461 ought to be seen in this context. Fouquet was no goldsmith like Gilbert Jehan, nor was he a tapestry weaver, glassblower, or embroiderer. He may have designed tapestries, glasswork, and embroidery, but he left the actual fabrication of these objects to other artisans expert in these ancillary crafts. His design work for the Tours *tableaux* was thus probably similar to his 'designing' of Louis XI's tomb, where Fouquet was paid for having 'drawn and painted on parchment' a *patron* of the proposed tomb, while Michel Colombe, a sculptor, was paid for having made a *petit patron* in stone.⁴⁶ So too with Louis XI's *poësie*. Fouquet might *devise* the canopy, in the sense that he specified elements of its design, but he referred its actual fabrication to a fellow artisan, Jehan Belin. As with these other projects, Fouquet's designing of the four *tableaux* was probably limited to making sketches. Others would take up the task of carpentry, decoration,

and acting that would bring his sketches to life. Because he was Tours' foremost painter, the Council naturally employed him for traditional painters' work, not pageant construction. The members of the Tours town council thus asked for Fouquet's advice on both the *poësle* and the pageant *devices* primarily because they recognized him as their most important local artist, one with royal connections at that.

5. Painters, *Patrons*, and the Designers of Royal Entries

Perhaps Hans Holbein's sketch for the pageant of the Nine Muses (London, 1533) is the most well-known of these *patrons* drawn up on the basis of a committee's *device*. In this case, a London committee, acting with the cooperation of the Privy Council, employed Nicolas Udall and John Leland to draw up a final list of *devices* and to write verses for the pageants. They would thus have drawn up the *device*. Perhaps with the prompting of the Privy Council, the Hanseatic Merchants agreed to take responsibility for one of these pageants, and they apparently asked their countryman, Holbein, to draw the preliminary sketch.⁴⁷ Holbein seems to have produced this *patron* in much the same way that Fouquet or Willem d'Hollandre produced theirs. There is no evidence that after producing the sketch, the artist had any further dealings with the builders of the pageant.

The sketch is clearly not meant as an architectural plan for the pageant. It constructs an idealised view of what the pageant might look like when constructed, but it is highly impractical as a guide for those actually constructing the pageant. Where do the two peaks of Parnassus rise to, for instance? In Holbein's sketch, they simply run off the top and side of the image. How is the pageant structure supposed to accommodate these and frame them? What exactly holds up that gazebo-like structure that enthrones Apollo? How does the fountain work, and what holds it up? For that matter, what do the Muses stand on, and how are they accommodated? The more one looks at the sketch, the more provisional and tentative it seems. It provides good inspiration, and it suggests a fashionable neo-classical presentation of the scene, but it does not otherwise provide any help with the practical business of constructing the pageant. Any competent carpenter would have to draw up his own plans, and one would expect that the finished pageant might look significantly different from this proposal.

In fact, we know that in several major respects it did look very different. Holbein sets the pageant atop a neoclassical arch across Gracechurch Street, and this is possible, but Hall's account mentions no such arch. Pageants

were customarily constructed at this point in Gracechurch Street because the conduit in the middle of the street provided a good base for erecting a large structure.⁴⁸ The pageant was certainly erected upon the conduit, because one of the pageant's central features was the Fountain of Helicon, which required a water supply. As imagined by Holbein, Helicon was to be a fairly simple affair, even if fashionably neoclassical in design. Water would invisibly be piped into the upper bowl, probably through the central shaft which connected the two. From there, it would spill out through two spigots and flow down into a larger bowl beneath. The builders of the pageant had a much more showy idea, however. As Edward Hall describes it, Helicon

was of white Marble &.iiii. streames without pype did rise an ell hye
& mette together in a litle cuppe aboue the fountain, which fountain
ranne abundantly Racked Rennishe wyne til night.

Moreover, the builders staged the *tableau* differently. Holbein arranges the Muses in two groups, five to Apollo's left, and four to his right. In the event, however, the pageant opted for a more symmetrical arrangement:

On the mountaine satte Appollo and at his fete satte Calliope, and on
euery syde of the mountain satte .iiii. Muses playng on seuerall swete
instrumentes, and at their feete Epigrammes & Poyes were written in
golden letters in the which euery Muse accordyng to her propertie
prayed the Quene.⁴⁹

This arrangement of the Muses necessarily required considerable alterations of Holbein's design. Does Hall's reference to 'the mountain' mean that there was only one rocky peak instead of two as in Holbein's drawing? Since Hall tells us that the Muses sat (rather than stood, as in Holbein's sketch) on 'every syde' of Parnassus, this would seem to suggest that they may have sat on two sides of a pageant mountain with Apollo sitting in the middle, perhaps atop the mountain. In moving Calliope and her gold-lettered *scripture* to sit at Apollo's feet, moreover, the pageant necessarily displaced the Fountain of Helicon. This probably happened because the builders decided that Helicon should flow with wine rather than water. Since by convention, such fountains were intended as largesse (as with the waters of Mercy, Grace, and Pity at Henry VI's Royal Entry), the fountain would have to be set lower and apart from the pageant so that the wine might be dispensed. The 'Epigrammes & Poyes ... written in golden letters' must also have marked an important departure from Holbein's design. Since these must be legible to all, the Muses cannot be arranged

behind one another as in Holbein's design. Perhaps, as a consequence, the builders opted for side-by-side seating.

All of these alterations suggest that Holbein's 'design' was treated with considerable latitude by the carpenters and painters, who felt perfectly free to alter it. It specifies the crucial elements of the setting (Parnassus and the Fountain of Helicon) and the necessary figures who must inhabit this setting (Apollo and the Nine Muses), but these were probably specified already in the *device*. It provides good advice upon how the elements of the pageant might be placed in relationship to one another, but in the end, this is only a suggestion subject to the practical necessities of construction and performance. Most of all, a *patron* like Holbein's defines a sense of style — neoclassical in this case — that might guide the builders as they work. Perhaps there is a good reason, in short, why the builders would not want the artist to become too deeply involved in the process of construction, particularly if he were to become too attached to his own design.

Because such pageant designs are ephemeral, few have survived from before the mid-sixteenth century. There may be more yet to be identified, however. What follows is necessarily very speculative and subject to future research. Here we will consider some images of Royal Entry pageants that appear as illustrations in presentation manuscripts. BL MS Stowe 582 commemorates the Entry of Queen Claude into Paris in 1517. It contains illustrations of the pageants painted by Jean Coene IV. Images are accessible on the British Library website (see note for URL).⁵⁰ There are similar illustrations in a presentation manuscript commemorating the Entry of Mary Tudor into Paris in 1514: BL MS Cotton Vespasian B II.⁵¹

Images from these manuscripts have frequently been used to illustrate 'pageant-stages'.⁵² There has not been very much comment upon these images, however, because they don't seem very competent as illustrations of these pageants. On the whole, they seem to be something of an embarrassment, particularly when compared to Holbein's sketch or to the illustrations of the pageants for the Entry of the Archduke Charles into Bruges. If one wants to understand what these pageants actually looked like, these seem to be mediocre at best, and they require a lot of imagination on the part of the viewer to understand them.

Much depends, however, on the source of these illustrations. What if these illustrations were not meant, in the first instance anyway, to be illustrations of these pageant stages in performance? What if the sources of these images are instead the *patrons* drawn up by an artist as part of the devising process? The artist in question need not have been Jean Coene IV,

the miniaturist who decorated the manuscript. The miniaturist may simply have gathered the *patrons* together and made versions of these for the manuscript he was commissioned to illustrate.

As *patrons* these make a great deal of sense. They show arrangements of characters in space, and give suggestions to the builders of how those characters should be arranged in the pageant when finally constructed. He is thus unconcerned about the practicalities of the mechanism by which the dove descends upon an actor portraying Claude on fol. 32^v, but he is very concerned about how Claude ought to be positioned amongst the other women to be portrayed. He differentiates the women into two groups, those dressed in clerical garb who stand on the lower plane, and those dressed in more secular costume *à l'antique* who flank the figure representing Claude. Unlike Holbein, he is also concerned with showing how the *scriptures* should be placed in relationship to the figures [PLATE 1].

Or consider such an illustration as the 'cup of Tantalus' pageant on fol. 36^v (there are several more of this type as well) in which the 'pageant stage' is divided in to two compartments. I doubt very much that this is what the pageant actually looked like: the important point to the artist is that the two groups of characters needs to be separated, but also connected by the figure of Foy in the upper register and the child Tantalus who dispenses liquor into all the upraised cups in the lower register. The lower compartment comprises an allusion to Philostratus' *Life of Apollonius of Tyana*, where Tantalus, 'the most friendly of men' offers his 'cup of friendship' to all who would drink of it provided that they share the dangers of their friends.⁵³ The point of the allegory is that peace mediated by faith (above) flows from friendship (below). How the pageant builders will achieve this design in wood, canvas, and paint does not concern him.⁵⁴

If we regard these images as visual records of the pageants as actually performed in the streets of Paris in 1517, then they will inevitably seem to be mediocre, if not incompetent, representations. However, if we regard them as *patrons* made by a quite competent artist preliminary to the construction the pageants, they will perhaps seem more sophisticated. What they are meant to do is to visually clarify relationships between the elements of the pageant as prescribed by the *device*. They function more as visual diagrams than designs. The carpenters, painters, costumiers, and actors would find these helpful in understanding the *device* and mapping out the relationships between the various elements therein. It speaks far more directly to the design process as they understand it — a process in which they assume the largest responsibility for translating ideas into art.

This image has been removed for copyright reasons. You can see the original if you buy a paper copy of *Medieval English Theatre* 32: see <http://www.medievalenglishtheatre.co.uk> for instructions on how to order.

PLATE 1: British Library MS Stowe 582, folio 32^v
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This brings us back, perhaps, to the journey taken by those two emissaries, Regnault de la Forest and Philippe du Pont, who were dispatched by the *échevins* of Nevers to view some tapestries at the Duke of Bourbon's castle in Molins. They were directed, we recall, to *rapporter par escript* on what they saw there. Sketches were not important; written descriptions were the order of the day. The verbal descriptions, apparently, became the primary means by which the features of design were communicated from artists — or in this case from a particular artwork — to the fabricators of Royal Entry pageants. It is a pattern that we frequently see being acted out in the negotiations that eventually result in the performance of such complex spectacles. As makers of finished artworks, of course, painters and artists are themselves the ultimate creators, but in the making of complex spectacles like these, they are ancillary workers, useful providers of information and inspiration to the real artisans — the carpenters, painters, actors, and costumiers — who design, create and perform in these pageants.⁵⁵

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NOTES

1. Comptes de Philibert Poinbeuf, 1 December 1457–November 30 1458, Archives communales de Nevers. I cite from *Ville de Nevers Inventaire-Sommaire des Archives Communales Antérieures à 1790* edited Abbé Boutillier, Curé de Coulanges, Série CC (Nevers: J. Vincent, 1876) 23–4. All citations relating to the preparations for this Entry are taken from this source. Relevant selections from Poinbeuf's accounts may also be found in Xavier Barbier de Montault 'La Tapisserie des Preux, a Saint-Maixent' *Revue Poitevine et Saintongeaise* 10 (1893) 246–47, and Abbé Boutillier 'Mystères et moralités du Moyen-Age joués par personnages ou simplement figurés aux entrées des princes dans la ville de Nevers' *Bulletin de la société Nivernaise des sciences, lettres et arts* series 2, volume 8 (1880) 154–5, which sources preserve some important details omitted in Boutillier's longer *Inventaire-Sommaire*.
2. For Jesse Trees and wine-running fountains as conventional epiphany pageants appropriate to the receptions of Royal Entries, see Gordon Kipling *Enter the King: Theatre, Liturgy, and Ritual in the Medieval Civic Triumph* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1998) 54–6, 59–60, 63–73, 315–17 (Jesse Trees); and 73, 144, 146, 163–7, 252 (fountains and wedding feasts).
3. Gertrud Schiller *Iconography of Christian Art* translated Janet Seligman, 2 vols (London: Lund Humphries, 1971) I 110. See Kipling *Enter the King* 115–29, 292, 325, 317 for epiphany motifs in female triumphs. Because the title specifically refers to 'Joseph of Egypt', the pageant probably did not represent the coat-of-many-colours episode, which occurred before he was sold into slavery in Egypt.

4. The *Passion de Notre-Seigneur* and the *Vengeance de Vespasien* were performed on succeeding days in Nevers from at least 1396 onward. Each was performed in a single day, and the *Vespasien* was thus more limited in scope than its famous successor, Marcadé's *Vengeance Jhesucrist*. These performances, discussed in Boutillier 'Mystères' 145–7, were apparently unknown to Louis Petit de Julleville *Histoire du Théâtre en France: Les Mystères* 2 vols (Paris: Hachette, 1880).
5. Henry VI entered Paris on 2 December 1431. At his approach to the gates of the city, the goddess of Fame met the King and led him through the gates and into the city. This incident was widely reported and much admired. See in particular *Collection générale des documents français qui se trouvent en Angleterre* edited J. Delpit (Paris, 1847) 243, but also *Journal d'un bourgeois de Paris* edited Alexandre Tuetey (1881) 274–9. For a discussion of the 1431 Paris Entry in general, see Kipling *Enter the King* 85–99.
6. The *échevins* also ordered 300 *banneroles* to be made for the *enfants* who would carry them in procession. They would probably have preceded the 18 Worthies, who would in turn have preceded the Duchess and her entourage. To make sure that the sight of the Duchess was not lost in all this splendid display, the *échevins* further paid for an elaborate *chappeaul* (crown) decorated with gold leaf for the Duchess, and the scribe, Jehan du Brueil, was paid for inscribing it with gold letters.
7. It may even be possible that the primary mission of de la Forest and Dupont was to copy out the *escripteaux* and *histoires* from the tapestries.
8. The process of designing a large-scale spectacle of the sort we are investigating varies, of course. Often these are centrally planned — London, for instance — but sometimes local civic traditions dictate that only a loose cooperation at best between guilds or organizations takes place — Paris, for instance — and each of these bodies plans its own contribution with considerable independence. For the Entry of Duchess Marie in 1458, the Town of Nevers thus largely followed the central planning model, with the *échevins* planning and paying for the entire production. Sometimes both models are in play at the same time; in Bruges, for instance, the town devises one group of pageants for a Royal Entry and other groups each contribute their own independent offerings. These are generalizations to which there are many exceptions, and they apply primarily to the design of civic royal entries from about 1370 to about 1550.
9. Remy Du Puys *La tryumphante Entree de Charles Prince des Espagnes en Bruges 1515* edited Sydney Anglo (Theatrum Orbis Terrarum; Amsterdam and New York: Johnson Reprint Corporation, [1971]) 20–21. Anglo's introduction to this facsimile edition, from which I take my information, supplies considerable detail about the planning committee's work and their meetings in the Blind Ass Inn. Those interested in the names of the members of the committee and in a considerably fuller account of the deliberations should consult Anglo's

introduction to his edition of Du Puys. One should also consult *Collection des voyages des souverains des Pays-Bas* edited Louis Prosper Gachard, 4 vols (Brussels: F. Hayez, 1874–1882) 2 531–42, where the original Dutch terminology is often highly informative.

10. They also supervised their construction, and arranged for the actors who performed in the *tableaux vivants*. For details, see Du Puys *La tryumphante Entree* 18–34.
11. 'Item, Willem d'Hollandre, for his pains taken in having made the 11 *patroonen* of the *tooghen*'; Gachard *Voyages* 2 534. In English as in Dutch the conventional word for 'design' or 'drawing' at this period is *patron*.
12. *Naer uutwysen den patroone ende der declaracie hem overghegheven*. The *patroone* probably refers to d'Hollandre's designs, and the *declaracie* probably refers to the written *device*; Gachard *Voyages* 2 533.
13. Du Puys *La tryumphante Entree* 8.
14. Kipling *Enter the King* 352–6.
15. Henry Noble MacCracken 'King Henry's Triumphal Entry Into London, Lydgate's Poem, and Carpenter's Letter' *Archif Für das Studium der Neueren Sprachen und Literaturen* 126 (1911) 75–102.
16. For the text of Lydgate's commemorative poem 'Ordenaunces ffor the Kyng made in the Cite off London', see John Lydgate *The Minor Poems of John Lydgate: Part II, Secular Poems* edited Henry Noble MacCracken EETS OS 192 (1934) 630–48.
17. John Carpenter 'Letter describing the London Entry of Henry VI' in *Munimenta Gildhallæ Londoniensis: Liber Albus, Liber Custumarum, et Liber Horn* edited Henry Thomas Riley (Rolls Society 12:3; London: Longman, Brown, Green, and others, 1860) 461–2. Layout slightly altered.

The Latin seems deliberately recondite, and we would like to thank Allan Hood of Edinburgh University and Henry Ansgar Kelly of UCLA for their help and suggestions over the translation. *Canon* appears in this instance to refer to a 'colleague', as does *consors*.

18. For reports of such shouts, see Kipling *Enter the King* 28–9.
19. Pageants gradually become platforms for public address at the end of the fifteenth and throughout the sixteenth century. Lydgate's poem, written to commemorate this occasion, may well have had something to do with it. In describing Henry VI's pageantry, Lydgate translates and transforms the scriptures posted on the pageant into what seems like speeches delivered to the young king. Thus Lydgate's report of this pageant reports Enoch's scripture as follows:

The ffirst seyde, with benyngne chere,
 Gretly desiryng his prosperyte,
 That noon enemyes have in him power,

Nor that no childe by ffalse iniquyte
 Parturble neuere his ffellicite;
 Thus olde Ennok the processe gan well telle,
 And prayd ffor the Kyng as he roode by the welle.

The actual Latin *scripture*, *Nichil proficiat Inimicus in eo ...* is placed in the margin beside this passage. The devisers of the next suite of London Royal Entry pageants, those for Queen Margaret in 1445, likely read Lydgate's poem (it was entered into the records of the Court of Common Council as a 'precedent') and thought it a good idea. As a consequence, they hired poets to compose actual speeches for characters to speak from the pageants for the first time: Lydgate *Secular Poems* 643. For the innovative use of speech in the 1445 pageantry, see Gordon Kipling 'The London Pageants for Margaret of Anjou: A Medieval Script Restored' *Medieval English Theatre* 4:1 (1982) 5-6.

20. I cite the Psalms as numbered in the Vulgate; the translations are from the Douay-Rheims version.
21. MacCracken 'Lydgate and Carpenter' 88-92.
22. Lydgate *Secular Poems* 641-2.
23. For a discussion of this pageant's allegory and its indebtedness to Frère Lorens, see Lydgate *Secular Poems* 163-7 and Kipling *Enter the King* 166-7.
24. John Somers, Baron Somers *A Fourth Collection of Scarce and Valuable Tracts Volume II* (London: F. Cogan, 1751) 470-71. After it had been published in Somers' *Tracts*, the original document apparently perished in the fire that destroyed the Earl of Hardwicke's library.
25. Somers *Tracts* 470-71.
26. London Metropolitan Archives MS COL/CA/01/01/004: *Repertories* vol. 4, 114.
27. Edward Hall *The Union of the Two Noble and Illustre Famelies of Lancastre and York* edited Henry Ellis (London: J. Johnson, 1809) 638.
28. Cambridge, Corpus Christi College MS 298 (no. 8) fols 138-9.
29. Minutes of a meeting of the Court of Aldermen, 5 May 1522, *Repertories* vol. 4, 117v.
30. William Lily *Of the tryumphe, and the verses that Charles themperour, & the most myghty redouted kyng of England, Henry the. viii. were saluted with, passyng through London* (London: Richard Pynson, [1522]) sig. [a iiij]. See C.R. Baskervill 'William Lily's Verse for the Entry of Charles V into London' *Huntington Library Bulletin* 9 (1936) 11.
31. Lily's employers seem to have thought he did a remarkably good job at composing his verses. Richard Pynson, the King's Printer, published an edition of his verse as a memorial of the event, and the city paid him a reward of the then remarkable sum of five pounds for his literary work. Perhaps more tellingly, the

- City also asked him for a copy of his verse 'to thentent that they may be entred for a president hereafter'; Baskervill 'William Lily's Verse' 3.
32. Jennifer Britnell *Jean Bouchet* (Edinburgh UP, 1986) 13. For the most influential advocates of Bouchet's activities as both a deviser and organizer of the Poitiers Entry, see Auguste Hamon *Un grand rhétoriqueur poitevin, Jean Bouchet 1476-1557* (Paris: H. Oudin, 1901; Geneva: Slatkine Reprints, 1970) 124-7, and Henri Rey-Flaud *Le Cercle magique: Essai sur le théâtre en rond à la fin du Moyen Age* (Paris: Gallimard, 1973) 137-43. The sole evidence offered is Bouchet's account of the Entry in his *Annales d'Aquitaine* which will be considered below. See, however, Hamon 127 note 1 for the most substantial rationale.
 33. *Le Roy fist son entrée en ladite ville de Poitiers, enuiron six heures de nuit, aux torches: ou estoient la Royne, & madame la Regente, mere du Roy, & luy furent faits les triomphes qui s'ensuyuent*; Jean Bouchet, *Les Annales d'Aquitaine* (Poitiers: E. de Marnef, 1557) 203v-5r. The passages cited below all come from these folios.
 34. Britnell *Jean Bouchet* 12.
 35. See Georges Collon *Pierre Bérard (139?-1465) et la réforme municipale de Tours en 1462* (Tours: L. Péricat, 1928); *Mémoires de la Société Archéologique de Touraine* 53 213-45, for transcriptions of the relevant Town Council minutes between 17 August (when the Council first learned of Louis XI's decision to enter Tours) and 20 December (when the matter of the Town's gift of a *nef* to the Queen was finally concluded). However, Collon's transcription must be used with some care. He prints the minutes of 31 October out of order, and he misdates it as '25 septembre à 31 octobre' (213).
 36. The Council received a royal commission headed by Jehan Paniot on 5 August; on this occasion, Paniot took formal possession of the town in the name of the king (224-5). For the Council's first reactions to Louis' subsequent decision to enter Tours and receive the town's submission personally, see Collon *Pierre Bérard* 227-8.
 37. Collon *Pierre Bérard* 229-31: *item, se on doit aler jusques à Amboise des gens de la ville faire la révérence au Roy et à la Royne ou se on doit atendre qu'ilz viengnent en ceste dicte ville, et se on doit faire don à l'autre et quel don, et quelz estaz et mistères on doit faire à la venue dudit seigneur soit advisé*. The gift to the queen, it was decided, would be *de quelque belle chose jusques à la valeur de L marcs d'argent, comme on dit les aucuns, les autres jusques à VI escuz, les autres jusques à IIII^c escuz, don't en sera à une autre assemblée délibéré*. As for the tableaux, the Council appointed a committee consisting of Jean Bonnart, Jehan Dupuiz, Jehan Peslieu, François Bernard, and Jehan Bernard to look into the matter.
 38. For the meetings of 25 September and 31 October, I cite from the transcripts published in 'Fouquet peintre et enlumineur' in *Jean Fouquet: peintre et enlumineur du xv^e siècle* edited François Avril (Paris: Bibliothèque nationale de France / Hazan, 2003), as the most recent and most accurate. Collon's transcriptions of

the same meetings (213–15, 233–5) are serviceable as well (except for the confusing dating of the September 25 meeting) and perhaps better organized to reveal the separate points of discussion. The transcription in Claude Schaefer *Jean Fouquet an der Schwelle zur Renaissance* (Basel: Verlag der Kunst Dresden, 1994) 347, however, confusingly intermingles the two sets of minutes, probably because of a printing error.

39. The text reads: *au regart dudit poële, sera faict de blanc et roge taffetas, et sera bleu, brodé d'un soleil ou meillieu semé de L couronnés, et les franges pareillement faictes d'or de Lucre. Avril Jean Fouquet: peintre et enlumineur 418–19.* It is not clear how it can be both made of white and red taffeta, and yet be blue.
40. At the council meeting of 25 September 1461, the committee was charged with devising the pageantry of the Royal Entry as follows:

Item, au regart des chafaux et des mistères, ils seront traser par Jehan Fouquet, après disner, en l'ostel mestre Jehan Bernard, et pour les divisez seront pris à ce ledit Me Jehan Bernard, Jehan Ruzé, Pierre Lailler, mestre Jehan Peslieu et Jehan Garnier; et après ce en feront leur rapport à l'autre assemblée pour en délibérer. (Avril Fouquet peintre et enlumineur 419).

Item, with regard to the scaffolds and the *mistères*, they will be sketched by Jehan Fouquet, after dinner, in the house of Mestre Jehan Bernard, and for the devices, they will be taken by the said M. Jehan Bernard, Jehan Ruzé, Pierre Lailler, M. Jehan Peslieu et Jehan Garnier; and afterward they will make their report about it to the other assembly for their deliberation.

41. At a subsequent meeting of the town council on 31 October 1461, the committee reported back as directed, and once again the minutes make clear that Fouquet's role was to draw up designs based upon the committee's *device*:

à ladicte venue et nouvelle entrée dudit seigneur en icelle seroient faiz les dix chafaulx, mistères et farces et pour savoir comment on les feroit, furent commis Jehan Ruzé, et lesdits maistres Jehan Bernart et Jehan Peslieu, Pierre Lailler et Jehan Garnier, et à en faire et tracer leur devis appelleroient avec eulx Jehan Fouquet, Pierre Hannes, Symon Chouain et autres et à la première assemblée ensuivant devoient faire leur rappor (Avril Fouquet peintre et enlumineur 419.)

For the said Coming and new Entry of the said Lord into the same (city), there shall be made the ten scaffolds, *mystères*, and *farces* [explanatory texts]: and Jehan Ruzé and the said Messrs Jehan Bernart, Jehan Peslieu, Pierre Lailler, and Jehan Garnier were commissioned to find out how they should be made, and Jehan Fouquet, Pierre Hannes, Symon Chouain and others were summoned

with them to make them, and sketch their devices, and at the first assembly following they are to make their report ...

The word *farse* comes from ecclesiastical Latin, and refers to 'explanatory passages in the vernacular interpolated between the Latin sentences in chanting the lesson or epistle'. *To farse* thus means 'To amplify (a liturgical formula) by the insertion of certain words; to provide (an epistle) with a "farse" or interpolated vernacular comment. Also, to insert (a passage) by way of "farse"; see OED sv *farce*. It does not refer to comic performances.

42. See note 41 above.

43. Pierre Hennes (or Hannes), painter, appears in the records relating to the painting of Charles VII's death mask. He rode from Bourges to Paris to find Fouquet so that he might work on the project. For Hennes, see Avril *Fouquet Peintre et enlumineur*, 418, and Paul Viollet 'Jehan Foucquet et quelques-uns de ses contemporains' *Gazette des Beaux-Arts* 23 (1867) 103–106. There is no reason to suppose, as does Trenchard Cox *Jehan Foucquet, Native of Tours* (London: Faber, 1931) 37, however, that Hennes was 'a master-artist' and a sculptor.

44. Fouquet, Hannes, Chouain *et autres* were paid 100 *sous tournois* for their *peines et salaires* (Avril *Fouquet Peintre et enlumineur* 419).

45. For references to these, see Avril *Fouquet Peintre et enlumineur*: tapestry designs (166–8), death mask (418), stained glass (164–5), medallions (131–7), tomb design (420), and canopies (418–19, 420); see Nicole Reynaud *Jean Fouquet* (Les dossiers du département des peintures 22; Paris: Éditions de la Réunion des Musées nationaux, 1981) for medallions (22–7).

46. For the record relating to Michael Colombe, described as *tailleur d'images* ('sculptor'), who fashioned a *petit patron* ('small model') out of stone of the proposed tomb, and Fouquet who paid primarily for 'having drawn and painted on parchment another pattern' of the tomb (*pour avoir tiré et peint sur parchemin un autre patron*), see Avril *Fouquet Peintre et enlumineur* 420.

47. <http://www.lib-art.com/artgallery/12431-apollo-and-the-muses-on-parnassus-hans-the-younger-holbein.html>.

For a discussion of the planning and devising of this pageant, see Gordon Kipling "He That Saw It Would Not Believe It": Anne Boleyn's Royal Entry into London' in *Civic Ritual and Drama in Medieval and Renaissance Europe* edited Alexandra F. Johnston and Wim Hüsken (Ludus: Medieval and Early Renaissance Theatre and Drama 2; Amsterdam and Atlanta: Rodopi, 1997) 39–79.

48. For Katharine of Aragon's Royal Entry of 1501, a pageant called 'Castle Policy' was constructed upon the conduit in the middle of the street and the structure stretched entirely across the street so that the 'hors weyes and passages was undre the wynges of this seid pagent'; *The Receyt of the Ladie Kateryne* edited Gordon

Kipling *EETS* OS 296 (1990) 15–17. Similarly, in 1522, the Hanseatic merchants erected another castellated structure across Gracechurch Street. It had ‘two great gates, one on the one side of the way and the other on the other side’, and these were anchored by three towers, one built upon the conduit in the middle and the other two at the far sides of the road; Hall *The Union of ... Lancastre and York* 638

49. Hall *The Union of ... Lancastre and York*, 801.
50. <http://www.bl.uk/catalogues/illuminatedmanuscripts/record.asp?MSID=6506&CollID=21&NStart=582>
51. https://imagesonline.bl.uk/?service=search&action=do_quick_search&language=en&q=Cotton+Vespasian+B.+II
All the illustrations of these manuscripts are reproduced in Pierre Gringore *Les Entrées royales à Paris de Marie d'Angleterre (1514) et de Claude de France (1517)* edited Cynthia J. Brown (Geneva: Éditions Droz, 2005).
52. E.g. Glynne Wickham *The Medieval Theatre* (London: Weidenfeld and Nicolson, 1974) plate 44; *The Cambridge Companion to Medieval English Theatre* edited Richard Beadle and Alan J. Fletcher (Cambridge UP, 2nd edition 2008) plates 2–3.
53. Philostratus *The Life of Apollonius of Tyana* translated F. C. Conybeare (Loeb Classical Library; Cambridge, Mass: Harvard UP, 1969) 186–7.
54. For a discussion of these illustrations and their allegorical meanings, see Kipling *Enter the King* 333–42.
55. Such relationships between devisers, painters, and pageant makers, of course, undoubtedly led to friction from time to time. An echo of this friction can be heard as late as the early seventeenth century in England, where Ben Jonson, who deemed himself as poet to be the true deviser and creator of the court masque, entered into a famous and acrimonious quarrel with Inigo Jones, the maker of pageantry. The classic modern account of this quarrel remains D. J. Gordon ‘Poet and Architect: The Intellectual Setting of the Quarrel between Ben Jonson and Inigo Jones’ in *The Renaissance Imagination: Essays and Lectures by D. J. Gordon* edited Stephen Orgel (Berkeley and Los Angeles: University of California Press, 1975) 77–101.